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The syntax and semantics of the verb in Ancient Greek: An introduction. By ALBERT RIJKSBARON. Amsterdam: J. C. Gieben, 1984. Pp. xii, 176.

R's Ch. I ('Introduction to the moods and tenses', 1–9) provides a semantic overview of Greek verbal morphology—with sketches of the semantic value of the tense stems, the role of lexical meanings, the expression of tense, and the basic uses of indicative, imperative, optative, and subjunctive in independent sentences. The remaining chapters examine these (and other) issues in detail: II, 'The main uses of the single moods and tenses in independent sentences' (10–48); III, 'The use of moods and tenses in dependent clauses' (49–96); IV, 'Non-finite verb forms: Infinitive and participle' (97–125); and V, 'Voice: Active, middle, passive' (126–57). An appendix (158) is followed by a tripartite 'Select bibliography' (159–61): a minuscule and idiosyncratic listing of 'General linguistic works' (two by B. Comrie, two by S. Dik, one by J. Lyons); an annotated listing of 'Handbooks of Greek syntax'; and a useful list of 24 'Monographs and articles on Greek syntax' (19 dating from 1970–82, four by R himself). The book closes with two excellent indices ('Terms', 162–72, and 'Greek words', 173–6); an index locorum is conspicuously lacking.

R's preface states that he aims to provide, 'both for University students of Greek and for professional classicists', an introduction to Greek verbal syntax and semantics which is 'concise, and yet comprehensive and linguistically up-to-date' (v). But he admits that 'up-to-date' refers to 'the framework of Dik's Functional Grammar'. We have, then, an odd sort of book. This 'introduction' cannot be used by those who know little or no Greek, since it 'presupposes a reasonable knowledge of the morphology of classical Greek'. Nor is it useful for professional classicists, who will find nothing new beyond the Dik-inspired Ch. V and other reformulations of well-known constructions, and who will probably prefer the more copious handbook treatments. The real audience consists perhaps of (a) students unwilling to consult the handbooks, and (b) linguists who want a good 'College outline' style survey for preliminary work, and who will then (one hopes) consult the handbooks. Subject to these limitations (and reservations stated below), R's admirably clear presentation will prove very serviceable.

The concise format apparently precludes secondary references (although Dik, notably, is exempt from this exclusion); still, one frequently wonders whether a particular idea is R's or someone else's. One can often fault R for omitting a particular reference, as when he introduces 'factivity' (51 ff.) with no mention of P. and C. Kiparskys' classic paper (1970). More frustrating still are unsupported statements like 'In the literature it is often held that ...' (83).

R rarely interprets his neologisms in terms of traditional terminology, and he fails to signal novel analyses. The theoretical explanations which he occasionally inserts (mostly diachronic) are superfluous: they are generally superficial, and do no justice to the problems; see his remarks on the historical present (22, 25), the gnomic aorist (30, 36, 39), and middle futures beside active presents (type *akoúō, akoúsomai*, 149–50).

Throughout, R omits precise indications as to relative frequency and distribution in the texts, except for statements that a construction 'may occur' or 'occurs rarely'. The unique exception is a statistical survey within a functional analysis of the passive (133–5); this is interesting but unoriginal (see M. Gross, *Lg.* 55.863–5).

Finally, R's 'syntax' and 'semantics' are disappointingly traditional. Apart from a disclaimer (132), verbal government is ignored; and despite intimations of the importance of word order for certain constructions (cf. 35, 74, 78, 114, 125), this entire issue is left without systematic consideration. The major exception is the chapter on voice, where the Dik-style presentation is new (for traditional Greek grammar), and reveals interesting points of contact with a number of current case-oriented (or functional, or relational) syntactic and semantic frameworks. [BRENT VINE, *Phillips Academy, Andover, MA.*]

Origin of the term 'shyster'. By GERALD LEONARD COHEN. (Forum Anglicum, 12.) Frankfurt am Main: Peter Lang, 1982. Pp. 124.

Shyster is a word whose etymology has until now been unclear. Although etymologists and lexicographers agree that it first appeared in the 1840's in New York City, to refer to an unscrupulous lawyer, there are at least twelve competing etymologies, with none a clear favorite. These etymologies (from Scheuster, the name

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